ANCHOR CHURCH

# DISCOVER MORE

## Discovery 1

Week 1: Experience God

All scripture is from the New Living Translation unless noted otherwise.

# EXPERIENCE GOD

## ANCHOR CHURCH'S MISSION STATEMENT

*We exist to help people pursue Jesus in every area of their lives.*

## THE FOUR WAYS WE HELP YOU PURSUE JESUS

- **Experience God** (Week 1)
- Grow in Groups (Week 2)
- Discover Purpose (Week 3)
- Go Make a Difference (Week 3, Discovery 2)

At Anchor Church we want you to personally experience God. That happens when you engage in a relationship with Him. God desires a relationship with you, but leaves it up to you to choose that relationship.

> *James 4:8*
> *Come close to God, and God will come close to you.*

To experience God in this way you simply have to start pursuing Jesus.

## START PURSUING JESUS

Our salvation is secure by believing in Jesus Christ and receiving God's gift of grace.

> *Ephesians 2:8–9*
> *8 God saved you by his grace when you believed. And you can't take credit for this; it is a gift from God. 9 Salvation is not a reward for the good things we have done, so none of us can boast about it.*

However, someone can be saved without ever experiencing God in a tangible way. In John, we see Jesus' future disciples taking it a step further than just believing in Jesus.

> *John 1:38–39 (NLT)*
> *38 Jesus looked around and saw them following. "What do you want?" he asked them. They replied, "Rabbi" (which means "Teacher"), "where are you staying?" 39 "Come and see," he said. It was about four o'clock in the afternoon when they went with him to the place where he was staying, and they remained with him the rest of the day.*

Notice they started following Jesus, and wanted to know where He was staying. Jesus' response is a powerful invitation to "come and see". Pursuing Jesus is simply accepting Jesus' invitation.

## PURSUING JESUS LEADS TO EXPERIENCING HIM

When you take Jesus' invitation this is what He says what will happen:

> *Matthew 11:28–30 (MSG)*
> *"Are you tired? Worn out? Burned out on religion? Come to me. Get away with me and you'll recover your life. I'll show you how to take a real rest. Walk with me and work with me—watch how I do it. Learn the unforced rhythms of grace. I won't lay anything heavy or ill-fitting on you. Keep company with me and you'll learn to live freely and lightly."*

- **Recover your life**

  > *Matthew 11:28–30 (MSG)*
  > *Get away with me and you'll recover your life.*

  Jesus will recover and restore what was lost and broken in your life.

- **Take a real rest**

  > *Matthew 11:28–30 (MSG)*
  > *I'll show you how to take a real rest.*

  Jesus will calm your fears and anxious thoughts and give you rest that can only come from Him.

- **Learn to live in His grace and freedom**

  *Matthew 11:28–30 (MSG)*
  *Walk with me and work with me—watch how I do it. Learn the unforced rhythms of grace. I won't lay anything heavy or ill-fitting on you. Keep company with me and you'll learn to live freely and lightly."*

  As you pursue Jesus you will experience his amazing grace and freedom over your life.

## NEXT STEPS:

- Take up Jesus' invitation to "come and see". Here's a good place to start:

  1. Pick a solitary place.
  2. Pick a quiet time with no distractions.
  3. Quiet yourself.
  4. Be aware that Jesus is with you.
  5. Pray. Share what's on you heart, give you worries and cares to Him.
  6. Read Psalm 1 or Psalm 23 as a prayer guide.

  Find out more on how to be with Jesus at Discovery 2.

- Attend Discovery 1 Week 2: Grow in Groups next week.

## QUESTIONS:

- Share your story. Tell us about yourself, how you got to Anchor Church, and your current journey with Jesus.
- What stuck out to you in today's session and why?